GRANT GUIDELINES

Community Impact Grants: 2027 Fall Cycle Guidelines

Competitive general operating grant · Opens July 12, 2027

At a glance

Funding: $5,000 to $25,000, determined by the organization's annual operating budget

Type of support: General operating support (unrestricted)

Term: One year (January 1 – December 31, 2028)

Total available: Approximately $625,000

Geographic eligibility: Organizations must be located in or provide services to residents of Coconino, Yavapai, Navajo, or Apache counties, Arizona.

Program page: https://hufsa-stack.github.io/cinder-peaks-community-foundation/grants/community-impact-grants-fall/

About the program

The Fall Cycle of the Community Impact Grants program provides one-year, unrestricted general operating support to organizations that strengthen learning, creativity, and the natural environment across Coconino, Yavapai, Navajo, and Apache counties.

Award amounts are based on the applicant's annual operating budget. The Foundation awarded $612,500 to 46 organizations in the Fall 2026 cycle and expects a similar level of funding in 2027.

Focus and impact areas

Focus areas: Education & Youth, Arts & Culture, Environment & Land Stewardship, Animal Welfare.

We welcome proposals that address one or more of the following impact areas:

- Early literacy, math, and school readiness
- Out-of-school-time learning and mentoring
- College and career pathways and opportunity youth re-engagement
- Arts access for youth and families and preservation of cultural heritage
- Watershed protection, forest restoration, and environmental justice
- Local food systems and renewable energy
- Spay and neuter access, humane education, and wildlife rehabilitation

Populations served

- Children and youth ages 5–18

- Opportunity youth ages 16–24
- Families in rural and tribal communities
- Traditional artists and culture bearers
- Rural pet owners

Eligibility

Geographic eligibility

Organizations must be located in or provide services to residents of Coconino, Yavapai, Navajo, or Apache counties, Arizona.

Who may apply

- Tax-exempt under Section 501(c)(3), a public or governmental agency (including public schools), a federally recognized tribe or tribal program, or a project with a qualified fiscal sponsor
- Located in or primarily serving residents of Coconino, Yavapai, Navajo, or Apache counties
- In operation for at least two years with a board-approved annual budget
- Non-discriminatory in hiring, board membership, and delivery of services
- Work aligns with at least one Fall Cycle field of interest: Education & Youth, Arts & Culture, Environment & Land Stewardship, or Animal Welfare
- One Community Impact Grant application per organization per calendar year (Spring or Fall, not both)

What we do not fund

- Organizations that received a Community Impact Grant in calendar year 2026
- Individuals, scholarships, or private school tuition
- Religious activities
- Capital campaigns, endowments, or debt reduction
- Lobbying or partisan political activity
- Fundraising events and sponsorships

Funding

$5,000 to $25,000, determined by the organization's annual operating budget. General operating support (unrestricted).

Award amounts are based on the applicant's most recent board-approved annual operating budget:

Annual operating budget	Grant award
Up to $75,000	$5,000
$75,001 – $200,000	$10,000
$200,001 – $750,000	$15,000
$750,001 and above	$25,000

Key dates

Milestone	Date
Application period opens	Monday, July 12, 2027
Applicant information session (virtual)	Wednesday, July 14, 2027, 10:00 a.m. MST
Application deadline	Friday, August 20, 2027, 5:00 p.m. MST
Board review meeting	Thursday, October 28, 2027
Decision	Applicants notified by November 19, 2027
Grant period	January 1 – December 31, 2028

How to apply

Applications are submitted through the CPCF Grant Portal during the open window. The Fall Cycle uses the same application worksheet as the Spring Cycle.

1. **Confirm eligibility.** Review the 2027 Fall Cycle Guidelines and complete the Grant Eligibility Checklist.
2. **Prepare your answers.** Download the Community Impact Grant Application Worksheet and draft your responses.
3. **Create or update your portal account.** New applicants create an organization profile in the CPCF Grant Portal. Returning applicants confirm that their profile is current.
4. **Submit the application.** Submit the online application, operating budget, and most recent financial statements by 5:00 p.m. MST on August 20, 2027.
5. **Site visit and decision.** Program staff may schedule site visits in September and October. Decisions are announced by November 19, 2027.

Review criteria

- Alignment with Fall Cycle fields of interest
- Evidence of community need and results
- Equity: the organization is led by, or meaningfully involves, the communities it serves
- Collaboration and partnership
- Financial health and sustainability
- Completeness of the application

Reporting requirements

Grantees submit a brief Community Impact Story Report at the end of the grant period.

- A short narrative (300–500 words) or photo story describing how the grant strengthened the organization
- Number of people served during the grant year
- Permission indicating whether CPCF may share the story publicly

Due: January 31, 2029.

Templates and supporting documents

- **Community Impact Grant Application Worksheet:** https://hufsa-stack.github.io/cinder-peaks-community-foundation/documents/templates/cpcf-community-impact-grant-application-worksheet.pdf
- **Grant Eligibility Checklist:** https://hufsa-stack.github.io/cinder-peaks-community-foundation/documents/templates/cpcf-grant-eligibility-checklist.pdf
- **Fiscal Sponsor Letter Template:** https://hufsa-stack.github.io/cinder-peaks-community-foundation/documents/templates/cpcf-fiscal-sponsor-letter-template.pdf
- **Community Impact Story Report Form:** https://hufsa-stack.github.io/cinder-peaks-community-foundation/documents/reporting/cpcf-community-impact-story-report-form.pdf

Frequently asked questions

Are public schools eligible?

Yes. Public school districts, charter schools, and Bureau of Indian Education schools may apply. A school's award tier is based on the budget of the program or school site, not the full district budget.

Can we apply to both the Fall Cycle and the Plateau Indigenous Communities Fund?

Yes. The Plateau Fund has a separate review process, and applying to it does not affect Community Impact eligibility.

Questions?

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